

NS

NetSec · CA24154

DELIVERABLE D1 · DOCUMENTATION PACK

Website & Open Directory

Architecture, design system, and admin
handover
for the COST Action NetSec website.

COST ACTION

CA24154 · Networking
European Security
Knowledge

VERSION & DATE

v1.0 · May 2026

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CSS



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netsec-cost.eu

What's in this document

A self-contained reference for everyone who builds on, hands over, evaluates, or simply uses the NetSec website. Each chapter stands alone; read end-to-end for a tour, or jump in by section.

01 Overview & purpose

What the site is, who it serves, and the principles behind every design choice.

02 Architecture

Tech stack, page-by-page inventory, data-flow diagrams for the weekly sync workflows, repository layout.

03 Design system

Colour tokens, typography, components, motion budget, iconography, accessibility checklist.

04 Admin guide

Every account, login, and asset the site depends on; routine tasks; escalation; handover checklist.

05 Appendix · Security & licensing

Coordinated-disclosure policy in brief, and the dual MIT + CC BY 4.0 licensing model.

How to read the diagrams

Diagrams in this document are the same Mermaid sources that live in the [docs/](#) folder of the GitHub repository. They render natively on github.com so anyone with read access can navigate the live versions there. The PDF embeds them as a frozen snapshot.

01 Overview & purpose

What the site is, who it serves, and the principles behind every choice.

What this site is

The NetSec website is the official front door of **COST Action CA24154 — Networking European Security Knowledge**, served at netsec-cost.eu. It is a static GitHub Pages deployment with two scheduled data-sync workflows and one third-party form processor. There is no database, no CMS, and no build step.

It doubles as **Deliverable D1** of the Action's Memorandum of Understanding — the open community directory that the Action committed to publishing.

Three audiences, one deliverable

Every decision in the site's design weighs three audiences against each other. A change that helps one without hurting the others is good. A change that needs to "pick a side" probably isn't ready.

The wider research community

Anyone working in or alongside European security studies. The site explains what NetSec is, who's involved, what's on the calendar, and how to engage.

Members & grant applicants

Practical resources: grant calls, the e-COST workflow, deliverables, the roadmap. The Network directory and Grants page are written for them.

External evaluators & funders

COST and the European Commission, for whom the site stands as visible evidence that Deliverable D1 has been met. Privacy compliance, accessibility statement, and licensing terms are written with them in mind.

Design principles

1. **Restraint over decoration.** White space, generous line-height, and one strong colour beat busy gradients.
2. **Glass cards as the unit of UI.** Almost every distinct piece of information sits on a glassmorphic card; they define hierarchy.
3. **Stroke icons for generic glyphs, brand icons for brands.** Same concept, same icon — every conference grant gets the same microphone; every contact item gets the same envelope.

4. **Motion is a hint, not a feature.** Hover transforms ≤ 4 px, transitions ≤ 300 ms, no parallax or scroll-jacking.
5. **British English** in all user-facing copy.
6. **Accessibility first.** Every interactive element is keyboard reachable; every colour pair meets WCAG 2.1 AA; skip-links land on `#main`.

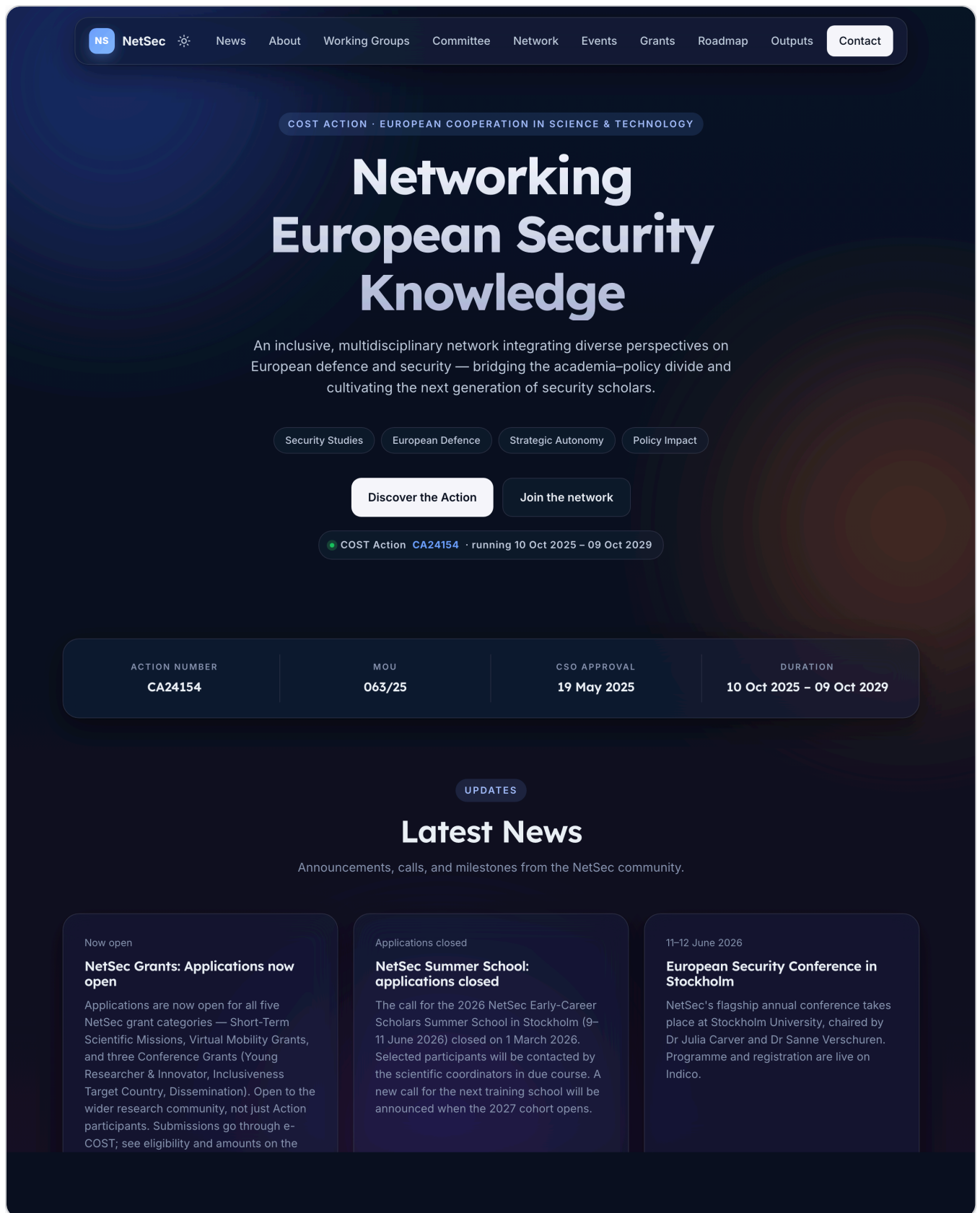


Figure 1 · Home page hero, light theme. Glass nav bar, gradient title, two CTAs, "Join the network" links straight to the open Google Form.

02 Architecture

Tech stack, pages, data flow, and repository layout.

Tech stack at a glance

The site is deliberately small. No framework, no transpiler, no bundler — just hand-authored HTML, one shared stylesheet, one shared script file, and two scheduled Python jobs that keep the data files in step with their upstream sources.

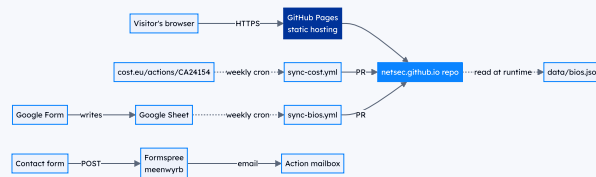


Figure 2 · End-to-end stack. Solid lines are HTTP requests at user time; dashed lines are scheduled batch jobs.

Three points to take from the diagram:

- **No back-end of our own.** Everything that looks dynamic (the directory, the grant-manager cards) is hydrated from `data/bios.json` in the visitor's browser.
- **Two sources of truth feed that file.** Member-submitted bios via a Google Form, and Action structure (WGs, leadership) via the COST website.
- **Workflow changes open a PR, never a silent push.** Every change to the directory passes through a human's review.

Site structure

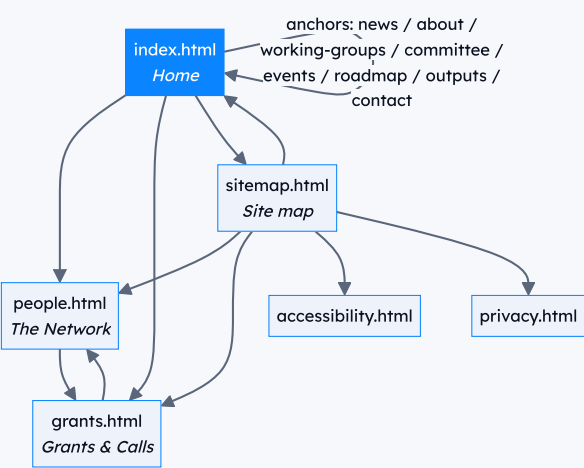


Figure 3 · Page graph. The home page hosts most of the static content as anchored sections; the Network and Grants pages are full-page applications backed by `data/bios.json`.

Page inventory

PAGE	PURPOSE	READS AT RUNTIME
<code>index.html</code>	Overview, news, WGs, Management Committee, events, roadmap, outputs, contact.	—
<code>people.html</code>	Open community directory with WG / MC / country filters; Join-the-network CTA.	<code>data/bios.json</code> (all)
<code>grants.html</code>	Five grant schemes, the e-COST timeline, resources, grant-manager contact cards.	<code>data/bios.json</code> (Grant Awarding Coordinator only)
<code>sitemap.html</code>	User-friendly site map linking every page and every in-page anchor.	—
<code>accessibility.html</code>	WCAG 2.1 conformance statement.	—
<code>privacy.html</code>	GDPR-compliant privacy notice. §10 is the licensing section.	—

Feature inventory

User-facing

- Light / dark theme with manual toggle and OS-pref default.
- Reveal-on-scroll powered by `IntersectionObserver`.
- Glass cards with `backdrop-filter`; graceful fallback.
- Country flags via FlagCDN for every ISO code (~200).
- Network directory: search × WG / MC chip × country, all AND-combined.
- Bio collapse: bios over 4 lines auto-add a "Show more" toggle.
- Awarding-process timeline with Before / During / After pills.

Operator-facing

- Two weekly sync workflows that open PRs rather than push.
- `data-bios-roles` attribute pattern — any element with it gets hydrated from `bios.json` at load.
- MC-member auto-tagging via `mc-members.json`.
- Brand-accurate social icons (Simple Icons SVGs).
- Stable slug-based member IDs for deep-linking.

Data flow — how a bio gets onto the site

The end-to-end path for a new member submission, from filling in the form to the live directory.

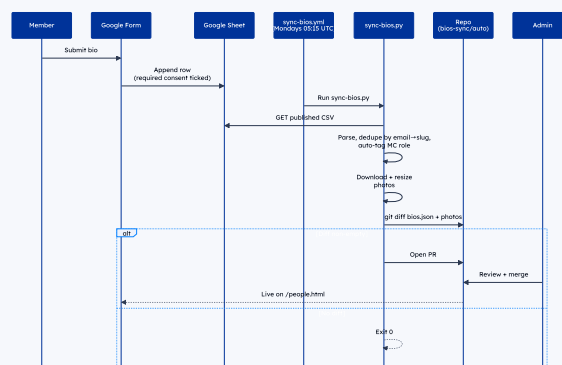


Figure 4 · Bios pipeline. Required consent on the form is what gates what reaches the Sheet. Photos are downscaled with Pillow before commit.

Data flow — how a cost.eu change propagates

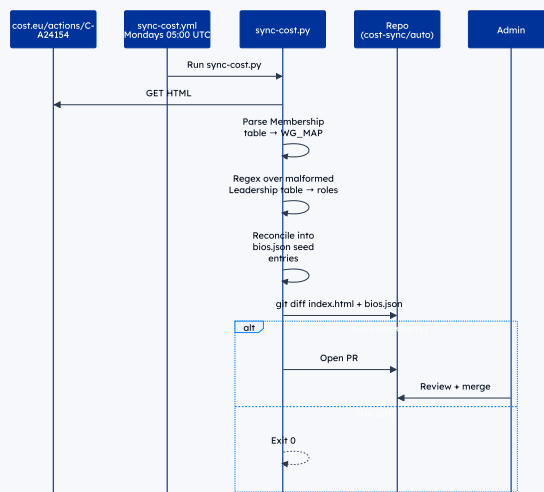


Figure 5 · cost.eu pipeline. The Leadership table on cost.eu has a malformed closing tag that breaks BeautifulSoup, so the script falls back to regex over the raw HTML.

Data flow — contact form

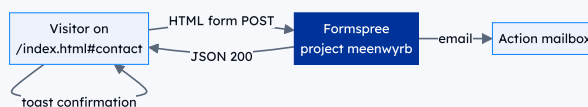


Figure 6 · Contact submissions never touch our repo. Formspree is the only third party that sees them, acting as data processor under Standard Contractual Clauses.

The Network directory in practice

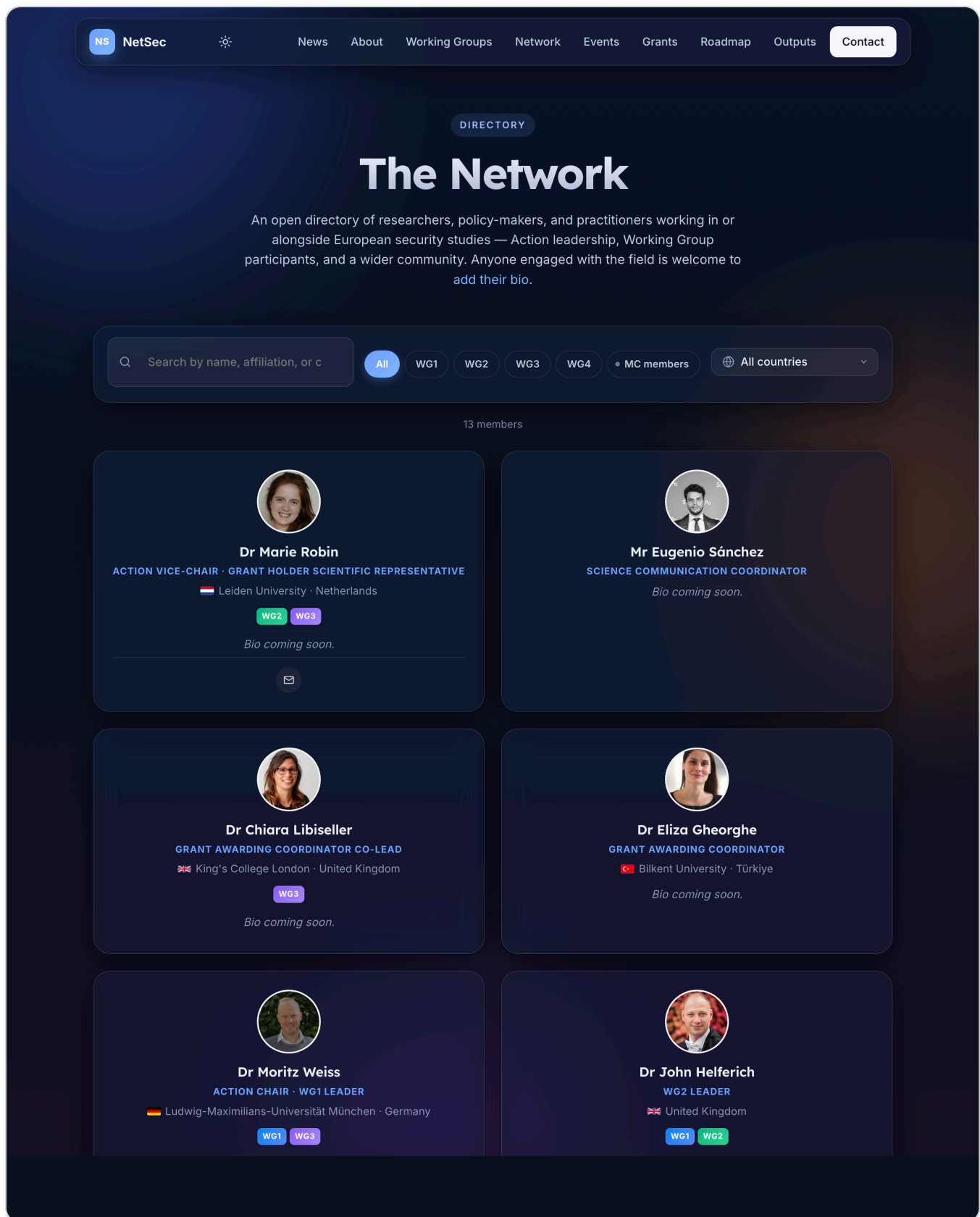


Figure 7 · The Network directory. Three filter axes — free-text search, WG/MC chip, country — AND together so they can be stacked (e.g. "MC members from France").

Repository layout

```
.
├── index.html                # Home
├── people.html              # The Network
├── grants.html              # Grants & Calls
├── accessibility.html       # WCAG statement
├── privacy.html             # GDPR notice
├── sitemap.html             # User-friendly site map
├── assets/
│   ├── css/site.css         # Single shared stylesheet
│   ├── js/site.js           # Nav, theme, reveal, accordions
│   └── images/people/*.{jpg,png} # Member headshots
├── data/
│   ├── bios.json            # The directory
│   └── mc-members.json      # MC roster per country
├── scripts/
│   ├── sync-cost.py         # cost.eu → WG_MAP + roles
│   ├── sync-bios.py         # Google Form → bios.json
│   ├── bios-source.json     # Pipeline config
│   └── requirements.txt
├── .github/workflows/
│   ├── sync-cost.yml        # Weekly cron
│   └── sync-bios.yml        # Weekly cron
├── docs/                    # Internal documentation
├── LICENSE                  # MIT (code)
├── LICENSE-CONTENT          # CC BY 4.0 (prose)
├── README.md
└── SECURITY.md
```

Conventions worth knowing

- **British English** in user-facing copy.
- **Slugs** are produced by an identical `slugify()` in both Python scripts (strip salutation, drop diacritics, drop apostrophes, lowercase, hyphenate). Both scripts must agree or member IDs drift.
- **Member IDs** are the slug of the cleaned name — stable across re-submissions, used as `id` on member cards so `/people.html#arthur-laudrain` resolves.
- **Comments in CSS / JS / Python** are full sentences explaining *why* the code is there, not paraphrasing *what* it does.
- **No JS framework, no transpiler, no bundler.** Anything more than that needs an issue first.

03 Design system

Tokens, components, motion, and the accessibility floor.

The site follows an **Apple-inspired glassmorphism** language layered onto EU and COST brand colours. It should feel modern, trustworthy, and Brussels-adjacent without ever feeling corporate.

Colour tokens

Defined in `assets/css/site.css` on `:root` (light) and `:root.dark` (dark). Always reference the token, never the raw hex.

TOKEN	LIGHT VALUE	USED FOR
<code>--bg-0</code>	<code>#f6f8fc</code>	Page background
<code>--bg-1</code>	<code>#eef2fb</code>	Slight elevation backdrop
<code>--ink</code>	<code>#0b1220</code>	Headings, primary copy
<code>--ink-2</code>	<code>#2b3850</code>	Body copy, sub-headings
<code>--muted</code>	<code>#5a6679</code>	Captions, meta, fineprint
<code>--line</code>	<code>rgba(11,18,32,.08)</code>	Dividers, low-emphasis borders
<code>--glass-bg</code>	<code>rgba(255,255,255,.55)</code>	Default glass card fill
<code>--glass-bg-strong</code>	<code>rgba(255,255,255,.72)</code>	Sticky nav, opaque cards
<code>--accent</code>	<code>#003399</code> EU blue	Primary buttons, focus rings, accents
<code>--accent-2</code>	<code>#0a84ff</code> Apple blue	Hyperlinks, secondary accent
<code>--accent-glow</code>	<code>rgba(10,132,255,.35)</code>	Soft glow under hovered buttons
<code>--ease</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(.22,.61,.36,1)</code>	Default transition curve

Dark theme inverts `--bg-*`, `--ink*`, `--line`, and `--glass-*` but keeps `--accent` and `--accent-2` identical so brand colour is constant across modes.

Typography

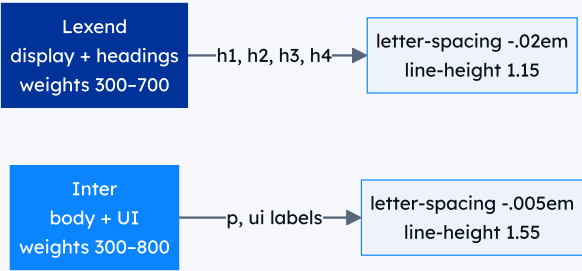


Figure 8 · Type pairing. Lexend's high x-height makes for friendly, fast-reading headlines; Inter is the most-tested body face for UI at small sizes.

Both faces load once from Google Fonts via a `<link rel="preconnect">` + stylesheet pair in every page's `<head>`. Heading hierarchy across the site:

LEVEL	COUNT	EXAMPLE
h1	1 per page	"The Network", "Grants & Calls"
h2	6–9	Major sections
h3	~20	Sub-sections, member names
h4	~18	Card titles, country names

Never skip a level (no `h2` → `h4`).

Component kit

Every distinct visual element belongs to a small, named set of CSS classes. Reuse the existing ones; don't introduce parallels.

`.glass`

The workhorse card — semi-transparent fill, blurred backdrop, soft shadow, hover lift. Used for news cards, member cards, country cards, grant cards, the search toolbar, and more.

`.btn` / `.btn-primary` / `.btn-ghost`

Primary fills with `--ink`, hover shifts to `--accent`. Ghost is transparent with a border and a slight hover lift.

`.chip` / `.wg-chip`

Pill-shaped labels. Working-Group chips are colour-coded 1–4 so a viewer can scan a member card and place them by colour alone.

`.timeline`

Vertical timeline on the Grants page — gradient rail with numbered nodes, Before / During / After phase pills, dashed-circle divider at the activity boundary.

`.mc-stats`

Three-up snapshot on the home page (49 reps, 30 countries, ~51 % women). Stacks to one column on phones.

`.members-toolbar`

Toolbar at the top of the Network page. Free-text search + WG / MC chip + country dropdown — all AND-combined by the directory's render loop.

Iconography

Two SVG styles coexist by design:

STYLE	WHEN TO USE	SOURCE
Stroke	Generic glyphs (envelope, globe, briefcase, microphone)	Lucide-style: <code>stroke="currentColor"</code> , <code>stroke-width="1.9"</code> , <code>fill="none"</code>
Filled brand	Recognisable brand marks (ORCID, LinkedIn, X, Bluesky, Mastodon)	Simple Icons SVG paths; <code>fill="currentColor"</code> (ORCID in brand green via <code>.contact-orcid</code>)

Same-concept-same-icon rule: every conference grant uses the same microphone icon; every contact-item uses the same envelope. Consistency lets users build muscle memory for what an icon means.

Motion

- `.reveal` — fades in + slides up 12 px when intersecting the viewport. Default state is *visible*; the fade only engages once JS has confirmed the observer fires. If JS fails for any reason, content stays visible — never invisible.
- `.blob` — three large translucent radial blobs in `.ambience` , drifting on a 22–34 s loop. Pure decoration; `aria-hidden="true"` .
- **Glass-card hovers** — 250 ms `translateY(-4px)` + shadow swap.
- **Theme toggle** — instant; the FOCUS-prevention script runs before paint.

Accessibility checklist for new work

- All interactive controls reachable with keyboard alone.
- Visible focus ring (use the existing `:focus-visible` style).
- `aria-label` on icon-only buttons; `title` for hover hints.
- Heading levels follow the hierarchy table above — no skipping.
- Colour contrast meets WCAG 2.1 AA in **both** themes.
- No content hidden behind `:hover` alone.
- Animations respect `prefers-reduced-motion`.
- Skip-link still focuses `#top` (home) or `#main` (other pages).

04 Admin guide

Accounts, routine tasks, escalation, and handover.

This section answers: "It's six months later, the maintainer is on parental leave, something needs editing — where do I start?"

Accounts & assets — domain and hosting

ASSET	LOCATION	OWNER / LOGIN
<code>netsec-cost.eu</code>	DNS registrar	TBC — confirm with Action Chair
GitHub Pages routing	Repo Settings → Pages	GitHub org <code>EISSeuropa</code>
TLS certificate	Auto-managed by GitHub Pages	n/a (Let's Encrypt)

Accounts & assets — code and pipelines

ASSET	LOGIN	NOTES
GitHub repository <code>EISSeuropa/netsec.github.io</code>	GitHub account in the <code>EISSeuropa</code> org	Action Chair, Vice-Chair, maintainer.
Google Form "Join the NetSec network"	Google account that owns the form	URL stored in <code>scripts/bios-source.json</code> → <code>form_url</code> .
Linked Google Sheet	Same Google account	Publish-to-web enabled (CSV). Required-consent step on the form gates what reaches it.
Published CSV URL	n/a (public capability)	Stored in <code>scripts/bios-source.json</code> → <code>csv_url</code> . Anyone with the URL can read the Sheet — the form's required-consent step is what gates the content.
Formspree project (id <code>meenwyrb</code>)	Formspree account	Free tier; submission destination is the Action mailbox.

Bus-factor reminder

Every admin task below assumes **at least two people** hold `EISSeuropa` org membership with *Maintain* permission on the repository. If that drops to one, escalate.

Accounts & assets — branding

ASSET	LOCATION	LICENCE
COST logo	<code>assets/images/cost-logo.jpg</code>	© COST Association — used per COST visual-identity guidance.
EU emblem	Inlined SVG in every footer	Used per the EU visual-identity manual for <i>Funded by the EU</i> communication.
NetSec wordmark	Pure CSS letter-mark — no asset	© COST Action NetSec.
Member headshots	<code>assets/images/people/<slug>.*</code>	© the individual, displayed with consent.
Country flags	FlagCDN (loaded at runtime)	Flags themselves public domain; CDN MIT.

Reviewing a weekly sync PR

Both sync workflows open a pull request against `main` on a dedicated automation branch. Either may be empty most weeks — that's a feature, not a bug.

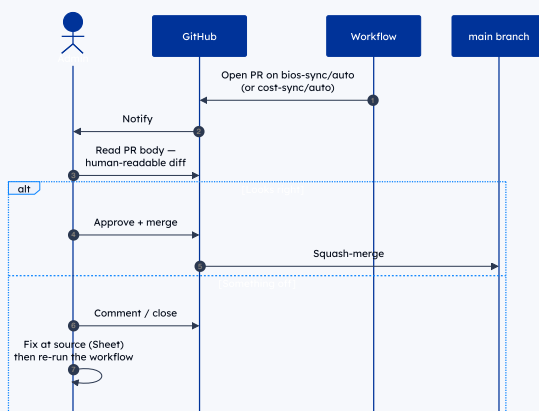


Figure 9 · Soft-review policy. No auto-merge — every new bio passes through a human's eyes.

The reviewer's job is **not** to fact-check research claims; it's to catch:

- Obvious typos (ALL-CAPS surnames, missing capitals).
- Broken or mis-targeted links (ORCID under the LinkedIn field).
- Photos that aren't headshots.
- Anyone who didn't tick consent (sync drops these automatically — but worth a glance).

Other routine tasks

Manually triggering a sync

1. Go to *Actions* in the GitHub repo.
2. Pick *Sync member bios from Google Form* or *Sync WG membership from cost.eu*.
3. Click **Run workflow** → **main** → **Run**.
4. Watch the run; if it opens a PR, review and merge.

Removing a member at their request

1. Delete the relevant `members[]` entry from `data/bios.json`.
2. Delete the headshot at `assets/images/people/<slug>.jpg` if present.
3. Open the Google Sheet and either delete the row, or clear the consent column (next sync drops them anyway).
4. Commit with message `bios: remove <slug> on request`.

Editing static page copy

1. `git checkout -b copy/<short-description>`
2. Edit the relevant `*.html` file.
3. Preview locally: `python3 -m http.server 8000` → open `http://localhost:8000`.
4. Open a PR. Merge once reviewed.

GitHub Pages rebuilds in ~30 seconds after merge.

The Grants page in practice

NSNetSec

NewsAboutWorking GroupsCommitteeNetworkEventsGrantsRoadmapOutputsContact

FUNDING & SUPPORT

Grants & Calls

NetSec funds five types of networking grants to support mobility, conference participation, and virtual collaboration across European security studies. Calls are open to the wider research community, not just Action participants — see each grant's eligibility for details.

**All applications are submitted through e-COST**, the COST Association's official portal — not on this page. Each grant card below links to the right place on e-services.cost.eu. Sign in with your e-COST account (free to create) and select COST Action CA24154 (NetSec).

MOBILITY

Short-Term Scientific Mission (STSM)

Supports a working visit to a host organisation in another country, for specific research carried out over a defined period — collaborating, using facilities, building new partnerships. The host must be in a different country than the applicant's.

AMOUNT	ACTIVITY	LOCATION
€ 2 100	In-person visit to a host in another country	Anywhere worldwide

ELIGIBILITY

- Open to anyone **affiliated in a COST Member country or NNC**, regardless of career stage.
- The **host organisation must be in a different country** than the applicant's affiliation.
- The visit supports the Action's objectives *and* the applicant's career development.
- Up to **50 % advance payment** may be released after awarding (STSM only — other grant types pay in full after the activity).
- If two or more STSM grantees share the same host, they must submit **original** (non-identical) scientific reports.

Apply on e-COST →

MOBILITY

Virtual Mobility Grant (VM)

The virtual counterpart of an STSM — structured collaboration with a host organisation in another country, conducted online. Same goals (research partnership, career development, achieving the Action's objectives), no travel.

AMOUNT	ACTIVITY	LOCATION
€ 1 300	Virtual collaboration with a host in another country	Worldwide online, no travel

ELIGIBILITY

- Open to anyone **affiliated in a COST Member country or NNC**.
- Collaboration with a host in a **different country** than the applicant's affiliation.
- The deliverable benefits both the grantee and the Action.

Apply on e-COST →

Figure 10 · Grants & Calls. All five NetSec grant schemes, with per-grant e-COST deep links and a vertical awarding-process timeline further down the page.

Escalation

SYMPTOM	FIRST PORT OF CALL
Site returns 404 / 500	githubstatus.com
Sync workflow fails	Actions tab → click the failed run → scroll to the red step
Form submissions stop arriving	Formspree dashboard
New bio doesn't appear after Monday's sync	Check Google Sheet (row present? consent ticked?) → manually trigger <i>Sync member bios</i>
Suspected security issue	Follow SECURITY.md — do not open a public issue
DNS / domain issue	Registrar admin; GitHub Pages settings as sanity check

Handover checklist

When admin responsibility moves to a new person:

- Add them to the [EISSeuropa](#) org with *Maintain* role.
- Grant them ownership of the Google Form + linked Sheet.
- Grant them access to the Formspree project.
- Make sure they have edit rights to the DNS registrar entry.
- Walk them through this document.
- Remove the previous admin's access (defence-in-depth).
- Update the *Owner / login* column above with the new owner.

A Appendix · Security & licensing

Coordinated-disclosure policy in brief; the dual MIT + CC BY 4.0 model.

Security policy in brief

Full text in [SECURITY.md](#) at the repo root. The shape of it:

Scope

In scope: the current [main](#) branch, the deployed site at [netsec-cost.eu](#), the two GitHub Actions, the Python sync scripts, and any personal data we hold.

Out of scope: older branches, tags, or forks; reports about COST or EU branding; volumetric DoS against third parties (GitHub, Formspreet, Google). Those go to the relevant vendor.

How to report

Two private channels — **not** public GitHub issues:

1. **GitHub Security Advisories** (preferred):

github.com/EISSeuropa/netsec.github.io/security/advisories/new.

2. **Email** the maintainer; for data-protection matters specifically, contact the Data Controller (Universiteit Leiden) per the addresses listed in [privacy.html](#).

What to expect

STAGE	TARGET
Acknowledgement	Within 5 working days.
Initial assessment	Within 14 working days.
Resolution — Critical	Patch in days; hotfix to main .
Resolution — High / Medium	Next sprint, typically 2–4 weeks.
Resolution — Low	Routine maintenance.
Disclosure	Coordinated; credit on request.

Safe harbour

If you make a good-faith effort to comply with this policy when researching and reporting an issue, we will not pursue or support any legal action against you. Good-faith means: only acting against your own data and the public site, avoiding privacy violations and service disruption, not retaining personal data of others, and giving us reasonable time to fix the issue before public disclosure.

Licensing model

The repository uses **dual licensing**, matching EU and COST open-access norms:

WHAT	LICENCE
Source code (HTML / CSS / JS, Python, GitHub Actions)	MIT
Site content (prose, page copy, documentation)	CC BY 4.0
Member bios and photographs	© contributors, used with consent
Third-party assets (icons, fonts, flags, COST / EU)	Their own licences — see LICENSE-CONTENT

Suggested attribution when reusing site content:

"Based on content from COST Action NetSec (CA24154), <https://netsec-cost.eu>, CC BY 4.0."

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The views expressed are those of the Action and do not necessarily reflect those of COST or the European Union.